



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

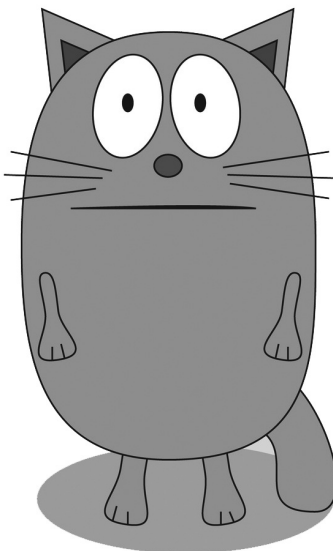
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Let's Start!

Regrets. I have had a few!



Learning Outcome

Describe hypothetical situations in written and spoken interactions according to work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- Do you have any regrets? If so, what are they?
- What do you wish you had tried or done when you were younger? Why?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about emotions, opinions and behavior in a work situation.
- I can talk about hypothetical situations in the past.
- I can ask for clarification and ask for someone's opinion.





Let's Explore!

It was an **awkward*** situation.

* "Awkward" means embarrassing or uncomfortable.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Yesterday was a tough day. First, in the morning, I scouted out the Corbin group and talked to an employee there named Roger, who I actually knew. He gave me some good insight into the organization. It sounds like an interesting place.

If only I had gotten his card the first time we met, yesterday's meeting wouldn't have been so awkward. If I'd had his card, I could have called beforehand and not seemed quite so desperate. Oh well.

In the afternoon, I had planned to contact Durban Inc. I talked about them previously, didn't I? Anyway, while I was at Corbin, a friend sent me an e-mail saying that Durbin had a job opening that I would be perfect for, but I needed to contact them immediately. I was so excited, but my excitement quickly turned to frustration; the position had already been filled ... that morning.

I remember badgering the HR director with questions on the phone. "The position is still open, isn't it? If I send my résumé now I can still be considered, can't I? You aren't looking for anyone else, are you?" It was humiliating.

If only I had stayed home that morning, I would have gotten the e-mail earlier.

If only I had talked to my source earlier in the week, I would have had a chance to apply. If only I hadn't gone to the Corbin group in the morning, I would have had a chance at this opportunity. Sometimes in life you make choices without even knowing it.





Let's Practice!

John has some bad timing!

Instructions: Write the given words in the appropriate blank space to coherently complete the sentences. Use capital letters where necessary. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

Word Bank

If only I hadn't gone to / I could have called / I had talked to my source / I had gotten his card / I would have gotten

1. If only _____ the first time we met, yesterday's meeting wouldn't have been so awkward.
2. If I had his card, _____ beforehand and not seemed quite so desperate.
3. If only I had stayed home that morning, _____ the e-mail earlier.
4. If only _____ earlier in the week, I would have had a chance to apply.
5. _____ the Corbin group in the morning, I would have had a chance at this opportunity.



Let's Practice!

John told you about his bad luck, didn't he?

Instructions: Organize the mystery sentence.

1. I / talked / them / previously, / I / ? / about / didn't

2. isn't / The / still / position / open, / it / is / ?

3. I / considered, / still / I / can / my / can't / be / now / send / resumé / ?

4. aren't / are / anyone / You / for / you / looking / else, / ?



Extension Activity

If you could give advice to your younger self, what would you say?

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Imagine you have three regrets from your past you would like to change.
- Write sentences about your regrets using hypothetical situations in the past to explain your regrets in detail.
- Share with a partner.
- Then imagine you can give advice to your younger self. What would you say focusing on your three regrets?
- Express your thoughts in 200 words.
- Read your advice to a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I use the third conditional to express regret about the past.

☐ ☐

I present my regrets to a partner.

☐ ☐

I write a short essay about giving advice to my younger self.

☐ ☐

I share my advice with a partner.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **beforehand** (expression): in advance, earlier
e.g. I could have called beforehand and not seemed quite so desperate.
- **insight** (noun): knowledge about something
e.g. He gave me some good insight into the organization.
- **desperate** (adjective): having an urgent need
e.g. I could have called beforehand and not seemed quite so desperate.
- **badgering** (verb): to bother or annoy continuously
e.g. I remember badgering the HR director with questions on the phone.
- **awkward** (adjective): embarrassing or uncomfortable
e.g. If only I had gotten his card the first time we met, yesterday's meeting wouldn't have been so awkward.
- **to scope out** (verb): to look at or over; examine
e.g. I scoped out the Corbin group and talked to an employee there named Roger, who I actually knew.





Learning Points

The Third Conditional

There are four types of conditional sentences in English:

1. Zero Conditional - to talk about certainty and facts
2. First Conditional - to talk about real possibilities in the present or the future
3. Second Conditional - to talk about *unreal* possibilities in the present or the future
4. Third Conditional - to talk about unreal *past* situations

You use the third conditional to talk about unreal situations in the past.

These are things that did not happen in the past. You often use the third conditional to talk about regrets.

Look at the chart below for the structure of the third conditional:

Conditional Name	Structure	Example
Third	<i>If + Past Perfect, could/would have + past participle</i>	<i>If only I had stayed home that morning, I would have gotten the e-mail earlier.</i>

Examples:

- *If only I had gotten his card the first time we met, yesterday's meeting wouldn't have been so awkward.*
- *If I had his card, I could have called beforehand and not seemed quite so desperate.*
- *If only I had stayed home that morning, I would have gotten the e-mail earlier.*
- *If only I had talked to my source earlier in the week, I would have had a chance to apply.*
- *If only I hadn't gone to the Corbin group in the morning, I would have had a chance at this opportunity.*

Tag Questions

You use *tag questions* to ask for clarification and confirmation.

Question tags are short questions you can add to the end of a comment.

They are mostly used in spoken English when you want to:

- **clarify/find out whether something is true or not true**, or
- **to prompt a response** from the person we are speaking to.

1. An **affirmative** statement is followed by a **negative** question tag.

Use this when you think the other person will agree by saying 'yes'





Learning Points

- You **were** taken by surprise, **weren't** you?
- You **are** Canadian, **aren't** you?
- She **has** a brother, **doesn't** she?
- He **can** speak English, **can't** he?

1. A **negative** statement is followed by an **affirmative** question tag.
Use this when you think the other person will agree by saying 'no'

- You **weren't** taken by surprise, **were** you?
- You **aren't** Canadian, **are** you?
- She **doesn't** have a brother, **does** she?
- He **can't** speak English, **can** he?

If the main verb is *to be* or a **modal verb**, the tag will be the same.
For **all other main verbs**, use the tag *do/does* or *did/didn't*.
Look at the examples in the chart.

Main Verb	Tag
He is/was	isn't/wasn't he?
You are	aren't you?
He can	can't he?
We could	couldn't we?
You will	won't you?
She has/had	doesn't/didn't she?
You have	don't you?
He likes	doesn't he?
You like	don't you?
You liked	didn't you?

Examples:

- *I talked about them previously, didn't I?*
- *The position is still open, isn't it?*
- *If I send my résumé now I can still be considered, can't I?*
- *You aren't looking for anyone else, are you?*

